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Review

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special emphasis, he sees the three books of Claudian's panegyric on the consulate of Stilicho as representing in the poet's mind a highwater mark in his poetic achievement. F. cites the allusion to the beginning of *Georgics* 2 in the first lines of *Stil.* 2, followed by an allusion to the first line of the *Aeneid* in the preface to *Stil.* 3: Claudian here invites comparison with Virgil. The reference at the beginning of *Stil.* 1 to the poet's earlier historical and panegyric works in the interest of Stilicho leads F. (in an appendix) to propose that Claudian invites the listener/reader to see this group of poems as a single epic of contemporary history, a 'Stilichoniad'.

More problematic is F.'s claim that the preface constitutes a distinct genre, with its own characteristic communicative situation and norms of form and content that shape the expectations and response of a reader or hearer. In practice, F.'s detailed discussion of the prefaces does not bear this out. Indeed, it is difficult to see what is at stake in claiming generic status for the prefaces since generic considerations rarely figure in the rest of the book. F.'s analysis reveals that Claudian's prefaces are, in fact, quite various, though the mythological (or historical or natural historical) allegory or comparison predominates. He identifies multiple antecedents for their form and content: the genre, if genre it is, does not predate Claudian. Nor does reception history bear out such generic claims. With the exception of the verse panegyrics of Sidonius Apollinaris, metrically distinct prefaces in the manner of Claudian are rare. Poets increasingly tolerate different metres within a single poem (for instance, the epithalamia of Ennodius and Venantius Fortunatus), while content—seafaring as a metaphor for epic composition, for instance—can be repeated in a metrically distinct preface and in the proems to individual books (Fortunatus' *Vita S. Martini*). On the basis of the evidence collected by F., it is perhaps more persuasive to claim that Claudian's prefaces, and especially the mythological comparison or allegory, are creations of a particular time and place, responding to the political circumstances and ceremonial context in which the poems were first recited.

In sum, F. provides a helpful guide to the scholarship on Claudian's prefaces and some worthwhile observations on matters of text and interpretation. He is less persuasive on the formal properties of the poems and their literary-historical status, where his book would have benefited from a less circumscribed and more wide-ranging approach to the influences on Claudian and to his reception.

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G. W. SHEA (trans.): *The Iohannis or De Bellis Libycis of Flavius Cresconius Corippus*. Pp. ix + 216. Lewiston, Queenston, and Lampeter: The Edwin Mellen Press, 1998. Cased, \$80. ISBN: 0-7734-8242-3.

Flavius Cresconius Corippus, a sixth-century grammarian from Africa, is known to us through two works in hexameter verse. The first, the *Iohannis*, written during the reign of Justinian (527–65), praises the Roman general John Troglita and his actions against rebellious Moors. The other, *In Laudem Iustini Augusti Minoris*, was written for the Emperor Justin II on the occasion of his accession in 565. *In Laudem* has been translated with critical notes by Averil Cameron (London, 1979) and Serge Antès (Paris, 1981), but the *Iohannis* has received less attention. There is only one manuscript, the fourteenth-century *Trivultianus*. It is lacunose, and the text is corrupt, which has left it open to much emendation over the centuries; the standard text now is that of J. Diggle and F. Goodyear (Cambridge, 1971). For his doctoral dissertation (Columbia, 1967), S. translated the *Iohannis* on the basis of the 1886 Petschenig text; this has now been somewhat reworked in the light of Diggle/Goodyear, though in fact S. still sticks close to the Petschenig text, with which he is more familiar. There is a short introduction, minimal notes, limited bibliography, and forty-eight textual notes. The introduction does contain some useful information, which helps in navigating the historical background to the poem. Granted the difficulties in the manuscript, the textual notes are crucial for indicating what text S. attempts to translate, but they are difficult to use and do not clarify S.'s views. It is sometimes unclear what reading he is following because he does not indicate whose conjecture is being used. Examples include 6.206 where *et armis* is conjectured for *arene*, and in Book 4.1 *displicet* is conjectured by Diggle for *ductor iacet*. At 2.105 S. replaces *tantum se iure litebit* with *tamen seu iure decebit* based on the conjecture of Mazzucchelli (*tamen*) and himself (*decebit*). He follows Petschenig at 3.126 when he replaces *dignos* with *cunctos* and again at 3.166 when *artis* is

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substituted for *altis*. S. follows Bekker at 7.502 when *huc* is conjectured for *hinc*. There are good reasons for the conjectures, but S. does not explain his preference, nor does he always note where there are serious textual problems, so that users of the translation are left in the dark: for example, he ignores the lacunae at 6.442 and 7.63. It should be noted that of the forty-eight notes which S. provides there are fourteen that are based upon Petschenig's conjectures. In conjunction with this there are numerous of his conjectures which S. uses, but does not signal to the reader. Examples include 2.33 where Petschenig's conjecture of *aeratas* is chosen over Mazzucchelli's *armatas*, 2.470 where this line is moved post-487 without being noted. In Book 4 ll. 35–7 are moved below l. 201 by Petschenig and S. follows, but he does not note the change. One final example is 6.442 where S. fills the lacuna with Petschenig's conjecture without acknowledgement. S. does not print a text, and it is safest to use S.'s version in tandem with the Diggle/Goodyear text and its excellent critical apparatus, but cross-reference is made considerably harder by the absence of line numbers (apart from the coverage of each page, printed at the top) and the lack of an index. S.'s translation provides a useful but expensive opening to a text which has deterred all but the specialists, but it has to be used with considerable caution.

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O. GRODDE: *Sport bei Quintilian*. (Nikephoros-Beihefte 3.) Pp. 103. Hildesheim: Weidmann, 1997. Paper. ISBN: 3-615-00189-3.

This monograph will appeal to two sets of readers, those with interests in rhetoric and in ancient sport, including gladiatorial contests.

Specialists in Roman rhetoric will find this work a complement to G. Assfahl's *Vergleich und Metapher bei Quintilian* (Stuttgart, 1932), which offers but a cursory treatment of sport (pp. 38–44) and gladiatorial combats (pp. 98–100). By Grodde's reckoning, allusions to these subjects comprise 15% of all the figures employed by Quintilian, and this monograph can be used as a commentary in which G. explains the relevance of the figure of speech to the rhetorical context. One interesting result of G.'s statistical analysis is the greater number of references to athletics than to gladiatorial or military combats (twenty-two to twelve), the former increasing in the second half of the *Institutio Oratoria* while the latter nearly disappear (only one example in Books 10–12).

Scholars of ancient sport will find especially valuable the use of the athletic allusions in the *I. O.* to assess the place of Greek athletics in the Roman world (pp. 76–9, 90–1). Because Quintilian, unlike his contemporary Tacitus (*Annales* 14.20), does not condemn Greek athletics, G. asks to what extent he was an advocate. Or was he actually hostile but paying lip service to a form of entertainment favored by his patron Domitian, who established the Capitoline Games in Rome in A.D. 86? While asserting that Quintilian's true feelings must remain elusive and that other writers did criticize Greek athletics, G. warns against the facile conclusion that the Romans were generally hostile. Indeed, on the contrary, the complaints about athletics can be construed to suggest the opposite, that their popularity was significant enough to merit censure. That Quintilian should employ athletic allusions in his *magnum opus*, a work aimed at the élite, indicates that he expected his audience to understand those references.

To be sure, Greek athletics did not become a component of Roman education. Yet Domitian did build a permanent stadium in Rome for his Capitoline Games, which continued into the fourth century A.D. Furthermore, the great imperial *thermae* were constructed with *palaestrae*, which served for some form of Greek exercises. For too long have scholars such as the highly influential E. Norman Gardiner, in his *Athletics of the Ancient World* (Oxford, 1930), p. 46, fostered an overly simplistic view that the Romans 'looked on athletics with contempt', conjuring up a Manichaean bipolarity between pure Greek amateur sports and brutal, bloody Roman spectacles. As Louis Robert emphasized, however, in *Les gladiateurs dans l'orient grec* (Paris, 1940), gladiatorial sports also became popular in the East, and we now understand better, thanks to scholars such as David Young, *The Olympian Myth of Greek Amateur Athletics* (Chicago, 1984), that Greek sports were neither so pure nor so amateur. Erich Gruen, in his *Culture and Identity in Republican Rome* (Ithaca, 1992), offers a more judicious and sophisticated analysis of the complex Roman reaction to Greek culture. G. contributes to this reassessment by enabling us to form a more balanced picture of the attitude in Rome toward the end of the first century A.D.

G. also makes an important contribution to our understanding of the ancient long jump. He